

ABOUT BELIEVE

What is Believe?

Believe is a global music distribution and artist development company headquartered in Paris, France. Founded in 2005, Believe operates in more than 50 countries and supports independent artists and labels at every stage of their career. In Germany, Believe operates through its brands Groove Attack and Nuclear Blast, among others. Believe's mission is to empower artists with expertise, technology, fairness, and transparency.

What services does Believe offer?

Believe offers digital distribution to 100+ streaming platforms and stores, audience development, marketing support, video channel management, publishing administration (via Sentic and TuneCore), and analytics through its proprietary DataMusic platform. Services are tailored to the artist's career stage — from emerging acts to established artists.

What is Believe's commission rate?

Believe charges a standard commission of 15% on gross digital streaming revenues for Label and Artist Solutions clients. This rate covers distribution, account management, platform relations, and access to Believe's analytics tools. The commission is deducted before calculating your net payout, as shown on your monthly royalty statement.

ROYALTY STATEMENTS

When do I receive my royalty statement?

Royalty statements are issued monthly, typically by the 10th of the following month. For example, your February 2024 statement will be issued by 12 March 2024. Statements are available in your Believe Backstage portal and are also sent by email.

What does 'gross streaming revenue' mean on my statement?

Gross streaming revenue is the total amount earned from all platforms before Believe's commission is deducted. It is calculated by multiplying the number of streams on each platform by that platform's per-stream rate. The net payout is the gross revenue minus the 15% Believe commission.

Why might my payout be lower than expected?

Common reasons for a lower-than-expected payout include: (1) fewer streams than the previous period, often caused by a track rotating out of a playlist; (2) a change in the platform's per-stream rate, which can vary quarter to quarter; (3) a shift in your listener geography toward markets with lower per-stream rates; (4) currency fluctuations if revenue is collected in non-EUR currencies and converted; or (5) a platform reporting delay causing some streams to appear in the following month's statement.

Why do stream counts sometimes differ between platforms?

Each platform reports streams on different schedules. Spotify typically reports within 3 to 5 business days after the stream occurs. Apple Music reports within 7 days. YouTube Music and Deezer may take up to 14 days. This means streams from the last days of a month may appear in the following period's statement. Small discrepancies between your Believe statement and a platform's own dashboard are normal and expected.

Why do per-stream rates differ between platforms?

Per-stream rates vary because each platform has a different business model and subscriber base. Platforms with more paid subscribers (e.g. Apple Music, Tidal) typically pay higher rates than ad-supported platforms (e.g.

YouTube Music free tier). Rates also vary by territory: streams in Germany or the US typically earn more than streams in emerging markets. Believe publishes indicative rates in your account dashboard, but actual rates are set by each platform and may change quarterly.

PLATFORMS AND DISTRIBUTION

Which platforms does Believe distribute to?

Believe distributes to 100+ digital stores and streaming services worldwide, including Spotify, Apple Music, YouTube Music, Amazon Music, Deezer, Tidal, Pandora, Napster, Anghami (Middle East), JioSaavn (India), NetEase and QQ Music (China), and many others. Believe holds Preferred Partner status with both Spotify and Apple Music.

What is a playlist placement and how does it affect my streams?

A playlist placement means your track is added to a curated playlist on a streaming platform. Editorial playlists (curated by the platform's team) typically drive the largest stream increases. When a track is added to an editorial playlist, streams can increase by 30% to 300% depending on the playlist's size. When a track rotates out of a playlist, streams often return to their pre-placement baseline. This is the most common reason for a significant month-over-month change in payout.

DISPUTES AND ACCOUNT SUPPORT

I believe there is an error in my royalty statement. What should I do?

If you believe there is an error in your statement, you should contact your Believe account manager directly by email within 60 days of the statement issue date. Include your statement reference number, the specific line item in question, and the discrepancy you have identified. Believe's royalty team will investigate and respond within 10 business days. Please do not attempt to resolve disputes directly with platforms — Believe handles all platform communications on your behalf.

Can Believe file a royalty dispute on my behalf?

Yes, Believe can file formal disputes with platforms on your behalf for documented discrepancies. This process requires your account manager's involvement and cannot be initiated automatically. Please contact your account manager to begin a dispute. Disputes typically take 30 to 90 days to resolve depending on the platform.

Who is my Believe account manager?

Your account manager's contact details are listed in your Believe Backstage portal under 'My Team'. For general enquiries, you can also reach the Germany support team at support-de@believe.com. Response times are typically 1 to 2 business days.